THE GENERAL ASSEMBLY

Chapter IV of the UN Charter embodies the provisions pertaining to the compositions, powers and functions of the General Assembly. Established in 1945 under the Charter of the United Nations, the General Assembly occupies a central position as the chief deliberative, policy-making and representative organ of the United Nations. Comprising all 193 members of the United Nations, it provides a forum for multilateral discussion of the full spectrum of international issues covered by the Charter. It also plays a significant role in the process of standard-setting and the codification of international law. The Assembly meets in regular sessions intensively from September to December each year, and thereafter as required.

Composition

Regarding the composition of the Assembly, Article 9 states that the General Assembly shall consist of all the members of the United Nations and each member, big or small, shall have not more than five representatives in the General Assembly.

It was at the San Francisco Conference that a limit of five seats was evolved in place of three as in the League Assembly.

Sessions

The General Assembly meets in annual sessions, which usually begins on the third Tuesday in September of each year. The sessions continue almost for three months. At each session the General Assembly elects one President and 21 Vice-Presidents (6 representatives from African States, 5 representatives from Asian States, 1 representative from an Eastern European State, 3 representatives from Latin American States, 2 representatives from Western European or other states, 5 representatives from the P-5 of the Security Council subject to the condition that the election of the President of General Assembly will have the effect of reducing the number of Vice-Presidents by one), and Chairman of Committees. The first session of the General Assembly was held in the Central